



MONTHLY UPDATE

Zambia: monthly update, July 2026

Edition of 2026-08-13 · 39 systems and instruments tracked, 55 of them not held

Developments recorded from artefacts published between 2026-07-01 and 2026-08-06 – July 2026 carried forward to the date of issue, so the report holds the nightly catch to the day it was cut. Sections follow the status report.

Summary of the month

Enforcement of the Cyber Crimes Act No. 4 of 2025 was declared fully operational on 18 July 2026, twenty-six days before the general election of 13 August ([enforcement account](#)). In the same weeks the state extended its collection systems to local government, reporting about K21.7 million from eight of 116 councils in their first month ([collection figures](#)), and launched a government-owned private 4G network for public institutions ([launch account](#)).

The month closed with the state ICT institute confirming that four named border posts still lack the connectivity the government network was meant to provide ([status update](#)).

Infrastructure

Connectivity

A government-owned shared 4G network for public institutions was launched at Ndola Teaching Hospital on 15 July 2026, run by the state ICT institute with three named partners and the health ministry ([launch account](#)). The reported outcomes are clinician accounts at the launch site; no baseline or measured result is held.

On 5 August the institute confirmed that connectivity gaps persist at Nakonde, Victoria Falls, Kazungula and Chirundu, and set a single national standard through the government network of tiered 10 to 100 Mbps bandwidth, dual links with automatic failover and enterprise-grade firewalls. A trade facilitation body has commissioned an audit of ICT infrastructure at five border posts; no budget, timetable or completion date is published, and the audit precedes the procurement rather than following it ([status update](#)).

Cybersecurity

The Ministry of Information and Media declared the Cyber Crimes Act No. 4 of 2025 fully operational on 18 July 2026, warning that recording, publishing or distributing private communications without authorisation could bring prosecution and singling out public servants on confidential information. Compliance obligations were stated as extending to financial institutions, telecommunications operators, digital platforms, mobile money providers and e-commerce businesses ([enforcement account](#)). The declaration falls twenty-six days before the general election of 13 August. No prosecution, charge or conviction count has been published.

Three days earlier the cyber security agency had urged journalists to learn the cyber laws, framing them as protection for media houses against ransomware and disruption.

The regulator reported on 4 August that it had deactivated 43,500 SIM cards linked to mobile-money fraud and secured K19.8 million between January and June 2026, on consumer reports through a short code, with no breakdown by operator and no prior-period comparison ([regulator figures](#)).

Digital public infrastructure

Data Exchange

The government service bus, the central integration layer, onboarded eight of 116 local authorities from June 2026 and now carries more than 400 government services with over K8.8 billion collected cumulatively across the service bus, payment gateway, national portal and payment platform ([collection figures](#); [Accountant General's office](#)).

Digital Identity and CRVS

Nothing published in the window moves the identity position. The most recent enrolment statement remains about 1.5 million of about 20 million people, roughly 7.5%, restated on 27 July ([switch account](#)), and biometric card issuance remains deferred until after the 13 August election.

Digital Payments and Fintech

On 27 July a vendor manager stated on the record that the National Financial Switch's intended reduction in customer transaction costs has not happened yet, that the central bank is only now focusing on it, and that the electronic clearing house is not yet live on the regional instant-payment scheme ([switch account](#)).

Sectoral management information systems (HMIS, EMIS, etc.)

The national electronic health record and its hospital tier are migrating onto the new shared 4G network, alongside the network's launch at Ndola Teaching Hospital ([launch account](#)).

Other GovTech and e-Gov

A contract tracking and management system was launched with the Ministry of Justice on 12 July for digital submission of government contracts to the Attorney General's Chambers and real-time tracking of approval progress; no volume or turnaround figure was published.

Digitalisation of sub-national government

The eight onboarded local authorities returned about K21.7 million in their first month, for property rates, business levies and permits, with Lusaka City Council urging business and property owners to use the platform on stated grounds of minimising revenue leakages ([collection figures](#)).

Use of satellite data

(narrative not yet written)

Governance and regulation

Legislation and regulation

Public consultation on the Postal and Courier Services Bill closed on 27 July, one working day after ten-province stakeholder consultations concluded. A ministry representative separately named a forthcoming Startup Bill on 17 July — the first and only mention of that Bill in the base.

Strategies, plans and policies

The head of the Presidential Delivery Unit said on 17 July 2026 that Zambia's National AI Strategy was nearing completion and invited stakeholder contributions ([statement](#)). Against that, a continental review published on 1 July reads a Zambian national AI strategy alongside six others as an existing analysable text. Nothing on file settles whether a draft has been circulated to researchers without being published, or whether the review is in error.

Regional collaboration

(narrative not yet written)

Data protection

(narrative not yet written)

Public debate and participation in policymaking

The same Postal and Courier Services Bill consultation — the only open public call for written comment on a Zambian instrument the wiki holds for the whole window — closed three days after the call for written submissions was reported, with no submission count, published response or consultation report held.

On 1 August the Human Rights Commission disclosed that its case review meeting had considered 105 alleged violations linked to the election period, of which 62 were resolved administratively.

Open data

(narrative not yet written)

Artificial intelligence and the technology sector

AI

The same 17 July statement disclosed an opportunity to establish Zambia's first artificial intelligence laboratory with the International Telecommunication Union, with no signature, funding, siting or timetable reported ([statement](#)). On 30 July the home affairs permanent secretary cited the cyber security agency's establishment as strengthening the response to online scams and artificial-intelligence-enabled trafficking, placing organised crime inside a cyber regulator's remit.

On 28 July an implementing partner published a first-hand account of automating public query handling at the National Assembly, consolidating budget and administrative data and surfacing information to members during debates and committee hearings. The same account reports parliamentary staff using public artificial intelligence tools on personal judgment, limited monitoring of what data flows into those platforms, and no consistent approach to hallucinations — findings the partner reports from two other African parliaments as well.

ICT Industry

(narrative not yet written)

Innovation ecosystem

(narrative not yet written)

Inclusion and capacity

Access to services

The same 27 July account puts financial inclusion at 80.1% of adults in 2025, with mobile money use at 76.2% ([switch account](#)).

Literacy

(narrative not yet written)

Training and skills

On 20 July the state ICT institute reported training 146 public officers across three district administrations of Southern Province; no cumulative national total is published.

Research institutions

The revenue authority signed a research memorandum with an international tax and development centre on 17 July, accompanied by a non-disclosure agreement, so whether taxpayer microdata moves is not disclosed.

Finance

New investments

On 27 July a domestic digital lender reported more than K500 million lent to over 120,000 customers since founding, and committed a further K500 million over the next decade — a forward intention by the lender itself, with no external financier named.

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